

US Patent & Trademark Office

Patent Public Search | Text View

United States Patent	12415419
Kind Code	B2
Date of Patent	September 16, 2025
Inventor(s)	Hasegawa; Kenji et al.

Display device, movable object

Abstract

A display device includes a glass pane, a display panel which is transmissive, and a glass panel unit. The display panel faces a prescribed area of the glass pane and is within the prescribed area. The glass panel unit is disposed between the prescribed area of the glass pane and the display panel and is within the prescribed area. The glass panel unit has an internal space which is in a pressure-reduced condition.

Inventors:	Hasegawa; Kenji (Osaka, JP), Uriu; Eiichi (Osaka, JP), Ishibashi; Tasuku (Ishikawa, JP), Yamashita; Shuji (Nara, JP)
Applicant:	Panasonic Intellectual Property Management Co., Ltd. (Osaka, JP)
Family ID:	1000008821235
Assignee:	PANASONIC INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY MANAGEMENT CO., LTD. (Osaka, JP)
Appl. No.:	17/767334
Filed (or PCT Filed):	August 05, 2020
PCT No.:	PCT/JP2020/029963
PCT Pub. No.:	WO2021/075127
PCT Pub. Date:	April 22, 2021

Prior Publication Data

Document Identifier	Publication Date
US 20220371440 A1	Nov. 24, 2022

Foreign Application Priority Data

JP2019-191498Oct. 18, 2019

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: **B60K35/22** (20240101); **B32B7/022** (20190101); **B32B7/05** (20190101); **B32B17/06** (20060101); **B60K35/00** (20060101); B60K35/50 (20240101); B60K35/60 (20240101); H10K59/80 (20230101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC **B60K35/22** (20240101); **B32B7/022** (20190101); **B32B7/05** (20190101); **B32B17/06** (20130101); **B60K35/00** (20130101); B32B2307/412 (20130101); B32B2457/206 (20130101); B60K35/50 (20240101); B60K35/60 (20240101); B60K2360/27 (20240101); B60K2360/785 (20240101); B60K2360/816 (20240101); B60Y2200/11 (20130101); H10K59/871 (20230201)

Field of Classification Search

CPC: B60K (35/00); B60K (35/22); B60K (35/50); B60K (35/60); B60K (2360/27); B60K (2360/785); B60K (2360/816); B60K (2360/347); B60Y (2200/11); H10K (59/871); B60R (11/02); G02F (1/1333); G09F (9/00)

References Cited

U.S. PATENT DOCUMENTS

Patent No.	Issued Date	Patentee Name	U.S. Cl.	CPC
2003/0134488	12/2002	Yamazaki et al.	N/A	N/A
2004/0160388	12/2003	O'Keeffe	N/A	N/A
2014/0078407	12/2013	Green et al.	N/A	N/A
2015/0253612	12/2014	Hasegawa et al.	N/A	N/A
2019/0197927	12/2018	Matsuoka et al.	N/A	N/A

FOREIGN PATENT DOCUMENTS

Patent No.	Application Date	Country	CPC
H11-198679	12/1998	JP	N/A
2003-258211	12/2002	JP	N/A
2004-529392	12/2003	JP	N/A
2006-162890	12/2005	JP	N/A
2007-071948	12/2006	JP	N/A
2018-052758	12/2017	JP	N/A
2019-117215	12/2018	JP	N/A
20180009086	12/2017	KR	N/A
02/101188	12/2001	WO	N/A
2014/050138	12/2013	WO	N/A

OTHER PUBLICATIONS

Primary Examiner: Ferguson; Lawrence D

Attorney, Agent or Firm: Rimon P.C.

Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE OF RELATED APPLICATIONS

(1) This application is the U.S. National Phase under 35 U.S.C. § 371 of International Patent Application No. PCT/JP2020/029963, filed on Aug. 5, 2020, which in turn claims the benefit of Japanese Patent Application No. 2019-191498, filed on Oct. 18, 2019, the entire disclosures of which Applications are incorporated by reference herein.

TECHNICAL FIELD

(2) The present disclosure generally relates to display devices and movable objects. The present disclosure specifically relates to: a transmissive display device (transparent display device) which is configured to allow a back (background) to show through the transmissive display device; and a movable object including the display device.

BACKGROUND ART

(3) Patent Literature 1 discloses a double-sided emissive transparent display device including an emissive display of, for example, organic EL, and the emissive display has an electrode part including at least one portion provided with a transparent electrode of, for example, ITO so that a background is visible through the double-sided emissive transparent display device.

CITATION LIST

Patent Literature

(4) Patent Literature 1: JP 2007-71948 A

SUMMARY OF INVENTION

(5) An object is to provide a display device and a movable object having improved durability while thermal insulation properties of the display device and the movable object are improved.

(6) An aspect of the present disclosure is a display device and includes a glass pane, a display panel which is transmissive, and a glass panel unit. The display panel faces a prescribed area of the glass pane and is within the prescribed area. The glass panel unit is disposed between the prescribed area of the glass pane and the display panel, is within the prescribed area, and has an internal space which is in a pressure-reduced condition.

(7) An aspect of the present disclosure is a movable object and includes the display device and a movable object body on which the display device is mounted as a window.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF DRAWINGS

(1) FIG. 1 is a front perspective view of a display device of an embodiment;

(2) FIG. 2 is a rear perspective view of the display device;

(3) FIG. 3 is a partially omitted sectional view of the display device;

(4) FIG. 4 is an exploded perspective view of the display device;

(5) FIG. 5 is a perspective view of a glass panel unit of the display device;

(6) FIG. 6 is a sectional view of the glass panel unit;

- (7) FIG. 7 is an illustrative view of the configuration of the display device;
- (8) FIG. 8 is an illustrative view of the configuration of the display device;
- (9) FIG. 9 is an illustrative view of the configuration of the display device;
- (10) FIG. 10 is an illustrative view of the configuration of the display device;
- (11) FIG. 11 is an illustrative view of an example of use of the display device; and
- (12) FIG. 12 is an illustrative view of a movable object including the display device.

DESCRIPTION OF EMBODIMENTS

(1) Embodiment

(1-1) Overview

(13) FIGS. 1 and 2 show a display device **10** of an embodiment. The display device **10** is a so-called transmissive display device (transparent display device). The transmissive display device is configured to allow a back (background) of the transmissive display device to show through the transmissive display device. The transmissive display device is configured to allow a user to see the background and show a video as needed. Moreover, the transmissive display device is configured to display desired information by superimposing the desired information on the background without impairing the visibility of the background.

(14) As shown in FIG. 3, the display device **10** of the present embodiment includes a glass pane **20**, a display panel **31** which is transmissive, and a glass panel unit **40**. The display panel **31** faces a prescribed area **210** of the glass pane **20** and is within the prescribed area **210**. The glass panel unit **40** is disposed between the prescribed area **210** of the glass pane **20** and the display panel **31**, is within the prescribed area **210**, and has an internal space **44** which is in a pressure-reduced condition. Note that in FIG. 3, the prescribed area **210** are shaded so that the prescribed area **210** is clearly shown. Moreover, in FIG. 3, the glass panel unit **40** is shown in a simplified manner.

(15) In the display device **10**, the glass panel unit **40** is disposed between the display panel **31** and the glass pane **20**. Since the glass panel unit **40** has the internal space **44** and the internal space **44** is in the pressure-reduced condition, the quantity of heat transmitted between the glass pane **20** and the display panel **31** can be reduced. Thus, in the display device **10**, the glass panel unit **40** can protect the display panel **31** from heat and can thus improve thermal insulation properties. Moreover, the glass panel unit **40** is protected by the glass pane **20** and the display panel **31**, and therefore, the possibility of damage on the glass panel unit **40** can be reduced, and durability can be improved. Thus, the display device **10** is improved in durability while the thermal insulation property of the display device **10** is improved.

(1-2) Details

(16) With reference to FIGS. 1 to 11, the display device **10** will be described in further detail. The display device **10** is a transmissive display device. As shown in FIG. 4, the display device **10** includes the glass pane **20**, a display unit **30**, the glass panel unit **40**, a protection plate **50**, a circuit part **60**, a buffer member **70**, a frame part **80**, and a cover **90**.

(17) The glass pane **20** has a rectangular flat plate shape. Moreover, the glass pane **20** is transmissive to visible light so that the background is visible through the glass pane **20**. In particular, the glass pane **20** is preferably colorless and transparent. Examples of materials for the glass pane **20** include soda-lime glass, high strain-point glass, no-alkali glass, quartz glass, and Neoceram. In the present embodiment, the glass pane **20** is a so-called strengthened glass. Examples of the strengthened glass include physically strengthened glass, chemically strengthened glass, and heat strengthened glass. Moreover, the glass pane **20** has a strength higher than the strength of the display panel **31** and higher than the strength of the glass panel unit **40**. That is, the glass pane **20** has a function of protecting the display panel **31** and the glass panel unit **40**.

(18) The glass pane **20** has a first surface **21** (see FIG. 4) and a second surface **22** (see FIG. 1) which are both surfaces in a thickness direction defined with respect to the glass pane **20**. The first surface **21** is a surface (inner surface) facing an inner side of the display device **10**, and the second surface **22** is a surface (outer surface) facing an outer side of the display device **10**. In the present

embodiment, the glass pane **20** has a generally uniform thickness. The glass pane **20** is partially bent. That is, glass pane **20** is a bent glass pane. More specifically, as shown in FIG. **4**, the glass pane **20** has one bent end (lower end in FIG. **4**) in a direction (up/down direction in FIG. **4**) corresponding to the vertical direction of the display panel **31**. Thus, the glass pane **20** has a flat surface part **201** and a curved surface part **202**. The flat surface part **201** has a flat rectangular plate shape. The curved surface part **202** is extended from one end of the flat surface part **201** and has a rectangular plate shape curved in the thickness direction. In the present embodiment, the first surface **21** is a flat surface at its portion corresponding to the flat surface part **201** and is a concave surface at its portion corresponding to the curved surface part **202**. The second surface **22** is a flat surface at its portion corresponding to the flat surface part **201** and is a convex surface at its portion corresponding to the curved surface part **202**.

(19) The first surface **21** of the glass pane **20** has a prescribed area **210** and an attachment area **211**. The prescribed area **210** is an area in which the display panel **31**, the glass panel unit **40**, and the protection plate **50** are to be disposed. In other words, the prescribed area **210** is an area to be used to display an image by the display panel **31**. As illustrated in FIG. **7**, the prescribed area **210** includes a transmissive area **210a** and a non-transmissive area **210b**. The transmissive area **210a** is a light transmissive area. The transmissive area **210a** has a rectangular shape. The non-transmissive area **210b** is an area surrounding the transmissive area **210a**. The non-transmissive area **210b** is a light non-transmissive area. Note that in FIGS. **7** to **10**, the non-transmissive area **210b** is shaded with dots so that the non-transmissive area **210b** is clearly shown. The non-transmissive area **210b** has a rectangular frame shape. The non-transmissive area **210b** is a darkly colored area. Note that the dark color can be black, blue, or the like. In the present embodiment, the non-transmissive area **210b** is a black layer formed in a prescribed area of the first surface **21** of the glass pane **20** by print technology. The attachment area **211** is an area to be used to attach the display device **10** to an object. In the present embodiment, the prescribed area **210** is an area corresponding to the flat surface part **201**, and the attachment area **211** is an area corresponding to the curved surface part **202**.

(20) In the display device **10**, the display unit **30**, the glass panel unit **40**, and the protection plate **50** are stacked on one another on the glass pane **20**. In particular, on the glass pane **20**, the glass panel unit **40**, the display unit **30**, and the protection plate **50** are stacked on one another in this order.

(21) The glass panel unit **40** is a vacuum insulated glass unit in the present embodiment. The vacuum insulated glass unit is a type of insulated glazing panels including at least a pair of glass panels and includes a vacuum space (or reduced pressure space) between the pair of glass panels.

(22) As shown in FIGS. **5** and **6**, the glass panel unit **40** includes a pair of panels (first and second panels) **41** and **42** and a frame member **43**. Moreover, the glass panel unit **40** has the space (internal space) **44** surrounded by the pair of panels **41** and **42** and the frame member **43**. The glass panel unit **40** further includes a gas adsorbent **45** and a plurality of pillars (spacer) **46** in the internal space **44**. Note that in FIGS. **5** and **6**, the dimension of the glass panel unit **40** are different from that in FIG. **4** so that the glass panel unit **40** is clearly shown.

(23) The first and second panels **41** and **42** are disposed to face each other. In the present embodiment, the first and second panels **41** and **42** are disposed to face each other with a narrow gap left therebetween. The first panel **41** includes a first glass panel **411** and a low-emissivity film **412** formed on the first glass panel **411**. The low-emissivity film **412** is a film containing metal, such as silver, with low emissivity and has the capability of reducing the transfer of heat due to radiation. The low-emissivity film **412** is formed on a surface, which faces the internal space **44**, of the first glass panel **411**. In the present embodiment, the low-emissivity film **412** is a so-called Low-E film. The size of the first glass panel **411** determines the size of the first panel **41**. The second panel **42** includes a second glass panel **421**. The second panel **42** is disposed to face the first panel **41**. The size of the second glass panel **421** determines the size of the second panel **42**. The

first and second panels **41** and **42** have the same shape. The first and second panels **41** and **42** each have a rectangular flat plate shape. The first and second panels **41** and **42** are transmissive to visible light so that the background is visible through the glass panel unit **40**. In particular, the first and second panels **41** and **42** are preferably colorless and transparent. Examples of materials for the first and second glass panels **411** and **421** of the first and second panels **41** and **42** include soda-lime glass, high strain-point glass, no-alkali glass, quartz glass, and Neoceram. In the present embodiment, the first and second glass panels **411** and **421** are a so-called strengthened glass. Examples of the strengthened glass include physically strengthened glass, chemically strengthened glass, and heat strengthened glass.

(24) The frame member **43** is disposed between the first and second panels **41** and **42** and hermetically bonds the first and second panels **41** and **42** to each other. Thus, the internal space **44** surrounded by the first and second panels **41** and **42** and the frame member **43** is formed. In the present embodiment, the internal space **44** is in the pressure-reduced condition. More specifically, the internal space **44** is in a vacuum state. In other words, the internal space **44** has a pressure in the interior thereof, the pressure being lower than the atmospheric pressure. The frame member **43** is made of a thermal adhesive (a bonding material). In other words, the frame member **43** is a cured thermal adhesive. The thermal adhesive is, for example, glass frit. Examples of the glass frit include low-melting-point glass frit. Examples of the low-melting-point glass frit include bismuth-based glass frit, lead-based glass frit, and vanadium-based glass frit. The frame member **43** has an outer shape similar to the shape of each of the first and second panels **41** and **42**. The frame member **43** is formed along outer perimeters of the first and second panels **41** and **42**. Moreover, the thermal adhesive is not limited to the glass frit but may be, for example, low-melting-point metal or a hot-melt adhesive material.

(25) The gas adsorbent **45** is disposed in the internal space **44**. Specifically, the gas adsorbent **45** has a circular plate shape and is disposed on the first panel **41**. The gas adsorbent **45** is in the vicinity of an outer edge of the first panel **41** (that is, an outer edge of the glass panel unit **40**). In particular, in the present embodiment, two of four corners of the first panel **41** are provided with gas adsorbents **45**. The gas adsorbent **45** is used to adsorb unnecessary gas (for example, remaining gas). The unnecessary gas is, for example, gas released from the thermal adhesive when the thermal adhesive is heated to form the frame member **43**. The gas adsorbent **45** contains a getter. The getter is a material having a property of adsorbing molecules smaller than a prescribed size. The getter is, for example, an evaporable getter. The evaporable getter has a property of releasing adsorbed molecules at or higher than a predetermined temperature (activation temperature). Thus, even when the adsorption capacity of the evaporable getter decreases, heating the evaporable getter to or higher than the activation temperature enables the adsorption capacity of the evaporable getter to be recovered. The evaporable getter is, for example, zeolite or ion-exchanged zeolite (e.g., copper ion-exchanged zeolite). The gas adsorbent **45** contains powder of the getter. Specifically, the gas adsorbent **45** is formed by applying and solidifying a liquid containing powder of the getter (e.g., a dispersion obtained by dispersing powder of the getter in a liquid, or a solution obtained by dissolving powder of the getter in a liquid). In this case, the gas adsorbent **45** may be reduced in size. Thus, even when the internal space **44** is small, the gas adsorbent **45** can be disposed.

(26) The plurality of pillars **46** are disposed in the internal space **44**. The plurality of pillars **46** are used to maintain a prescribed space between the first and second panels **41** and **42**. That is, the plurality of pillars **46** are used to maintain a desired distance between the first and second panels **41** and **42**. Note that, sizes of the pillars **46**, the number of the pillars **46**, the interval between the pillars **46**, and the arrangement pattern of the pillars **46** may be accordingly selected. Each pillar **46** has a solid cylindrical shape having substantially the same height as the prescribed gap. For example, each pillar **46** is preferably dimensioned so as to be visually less obvious to a user. For example, each pillar **46** has a diameter of 1 mm and a height of 100 μm . Note that each pillar **46** may have a desired shape such as a prism shape or a spherical shape. Each of the plurality of pillars

46 may be entirely or partially made of a resin such as polyimide.

(27) The glass panel unit **40** further has an exhaust port **47**. The exhaust port **47** is formed in at least one of the first panel **41** or the second panel **42**. In the present embodiment, the exhaust port **47** is formed in only the first panel **41**. Moreover, the exhaust port **47** is in the vicinity of the outer edge of the first panel **41** (that is, the outer edge of the glass panel unit **40**). In the present embodiment, the exhaust port **47** is located at a corner of the first panel **41**. The exhaust port **47** is used to reduce the pressure in the internal space **44**. That is, gas in the internal space **44** is exhausted via the exhaust port **47**, thereby achieving the pressure-reduced condition in the internal space **44**. After the pressure-reduced condition in the internal space **44** is achieved, the exhaust port **47** is sealed. To seal the exhaust port **47**, a sealing material **48** and a pressing member **49** are used. The sealing material **48** and the pressing member **49** are each dimensioned so as to be insertable in the exhaust port **47**. The sealing material **48** is, for example, glass frit. The pressing member **49** has a plate shape. The pressing member **49** is disposed on an opposite side of the sealing material **48** from the second panel **42**. While the gas is exhausted via the exhaust port **47** from the internal space **44**, the sealing material **48** is melted, and the pressing member **49** deforms the sealing material **48**, thereby closing the exhaust port **47**. Thus, the internal space **44** is sealed with the internal space **44** being in the pressure-reduced condition.

(28) The glass panel unit **40** has a generally rectangular plate shape. As shown in FIG. **8**, the glass panel unit **40** is disposed on the first surface **21** of the glass pane **20**. More specifically, the glass panel unit **40** is disposed in the prescribed area **210** of the glass pane **20**. The glass panel unit **40** has a size within the prescribed area **210** of the glass pane **20**. The dimension of the glass panel unit **40** is equal to the dimension of the glass pane **20** in a direction corresponding to the lateral direction of the display panel **31** (left/right direction in FIG. **8**). In the present embodiment, the glass panel unit **40** is greater than the transmissive area **210a** of the prescribed area **210**, and the outer edge (including the frame member **43**) of the glass panel unit **40** is in the non-transmissive area **210b**. In particular, both side surfaces of the glass pane **20** coincide with both side surfaces of the glass panel unit **40** in both directions corresponding to the lateral direction of the display panel **31** (left/right direction in FIG. **8**). Moreover, a side surface of the glass pane **20** coincides with a side surface of the glass panel unit **40** in one direction corresponding to the vertical direction of the display panel **31** (upward direction in FIG. **8**). Moreover, in the glass panel unit **40**, the gas adsorbent **45** and the exhaust port **47** are located in the vicinity of the outer edge of the glass panel unit **40**. In the present embodiment, the gas adsorbent **45** and the exhaust port **47** are also in the non-transmissive area **210b**. In FIG. **8**, the gas adsorbent **45** and the exhaust port **47** are not shown.

(29) The display unit **30** is a function unit for displaying an image **P10** (see FIG. **11**). The display unit **30** includes the display panel **31** and a driver **32**.

(30) The display panel **31** is a transmissive display. Examples of the transmissive display include a display including a transparent organic light-emitting diode (OLED). Note that the configuration of displaying images by the display panel **31** may be a conventionally known configuration, and the detailed description thereof is thus omitted. The display panel **31** has a generally rectangular plate shape. As shown in FIGS. **3** and **9**, the display panel **31** is disposed on an opposite surface of the glass panel unit **40** from the glass pane **20**. More specifically, the display panel **31** is disposed in the prescribed area **210** of the glass pane **20** in plan view. The display panel **31** has a size within the prescribed area **210** of the glass pane **20**. The dimension of the display panel **31** is smaller than the dimension of the glass pane **20** in the direction corresponding to the lateral direction of the display panel **31** (left/right direction in FIG. **9**) but is greater than the dimension of the transmissive area **210a** of the prescribed area **210**. In the present embodiment, the display panel **31** is greater than the transmissive area **210a** of the prescribed area **210**, and the display panel **31** has an outer edge located in the non-transmissive area **210b**. In particular, both side surfaces of the display panel **31** are on an inner side of the display device **10** with respect to both the side surfaces of the glass pane **20** in both the directions corresponding to the lateral direction of the display panel **31** (left/right

direction in FIG. 9). Moreover, a side surface of the display panel 31 is on an inner side of the display device 10 with respect to the side surface of the glass pane 20 in the one direction corresponding to the vertical direction of the display panel 31 (upward direction in FIG. 9).

(31) The driver 32 is a device for controlling the display panel 31 to display an image onto the display panel 31. The configuration of the driver 32 may be a conventionally known configuration, and the detailed description thereof is thus omitted. The driver 32 is disposed not to overlap the display panel 31. In the present embodiment, the driver 32 is disposed, at one end (lower end in FIG. 9) in the vertical direction (length direction, height direction) of the display panel 31, along the lateral direction (width direction) of the display panel 31. As shown in FIGS. 3 and 9, the driver 32 is disposed on the opposite surface of the glass panel unit 40 from the glass pane 20. That is, the glass panel unit 40 is not only between the display panel 31 and the prescribed area 210 of the glass pane 20 but also between the driver 32 and the prescribed area 210 of the glass pane 20.

(32) The protection plate 50 has a generally rectangular flat plate shape. As shown in FIGS. 3 and 10, the protection plate 50 is disposed on an opposite side of the display panel 31 from the glass panel unit 40. More specifically, the protection plate 50 is disposed in the prescribed area 210 of the glass pane 20 in plan view. The protection plate 50 has a size within the prescribed area 210 of the glass pane 20. The dimension of the protection plate 50 is equal to the dimension of the glass pane 20 in the direction corresponding to the lateral direction of the display panel 31 (left/right direction in FIG. 10). In the present embodiment, the protection plate 50 is greater than the transmissive area 210a of the prescribed area 210, and the protection plate 50 has an outer edge in the non-transmissive area 210b. In particular, both the side surfaces of the glass pane 20 coincide with both side surfaces of the protection plate 50 in both the directions corresponding to the lateral direction of the display panel 31 (left/right direction in FIG. 10). Moreover, the side surface of the glass pane 20 coincide with a side surface of the protection plate 50 in the one direction corresponding to the vertical direction of the display panel 31 (upper direction in FIG. 10). Note that the protection plate 50 has a dimension set in a direction corresponding to the vertical direction of the display panel 31 such that the driver 32 is exposed. Moreover, the protection plate 50 has generally the same thickness. Both surfaces in a thickness direction defined with respect to the protection plate 50 are flat surfaces. Moreover, the protection plate 50 is transmissive to visible light so that an image projected by the display panel 31 is visible through the protection plate 50. In particular, the protection plate 50 is preferably colorless and transparent. Examples of materials for the protection plate 50 include soda-lime glass, high strain-point glass, no-alkali glass, quartz glass, and Neoceram. In the present embodiment, the protection plate 50 is a so-called strengthened glass. Examples of the strengthened glass include physically strengthened glass, chemically strengthened glass, and heat strengthened glass. Moreover, the protection plate 50 has a strength higher than the strength of the display panel 31 and higher than the strength of the glass panel unit 40. That is, the protection plate 50 has a function of protecting the display panel 31 and the glass panel unit 40.

(33) The circuit part 60 is a function unit for controlling the display unit 30. The circuit part 60 controls, based on an image signal (video signal) given from an external device, the display unit 30 to cause the display panel 31 to display an image. The circuit part 60 is disposed in the prescribed area 210 on the first surface 21 of the glass pane 20. In particular, the circuit part 60 is disposed in the vicinity of the attachment area 211 in the non-transmissive area 210b of the prescribed area 210.

(34) As shown in FIG. 3, the buffer member 70 is disposed between the glass panel unit 40 and the circuit part 60. The buffer member 70 prevents the glass panel unit 40 and the circuit part 60 from coming into collision with each other, thereby protecting the glass panel unit 40 and the circuit part 60. The buffer member 70 has an elongated square bar shape. The buffer member 70 may be made of a well-known material as a buffer material such as urethane foam.

(35) The frame part 80 is configured to collectively cover at least part of the outer edge of the glass pane 20, the display panel 31, the glass panel unit 40, and the protection plate 50. In particular, in

the present embodiment, the glass pane **20**, the display panel **31**, the glass panel unit **40**, and the protection plate **50** each have a rectangular plate shape. As shown in FIGS. **1** and **2**, the frame part **80** is configured to cover three sides of four sides constituting the outer edge of the glass pane **20**, the display panel **31**, the glass panel unit **40**, and the protection plate **50**. In particular, the frame part **80** covers three sides corresponding to the prescribed area **210** of the glass pane **20** of the four sides constituting the outer edge of the glass pane **20**, the display panel **31**, the glass panel unit **40**, and the protection plate **50**. As shown in FIG. **4**, the frame part **80** includes a first side part **81** and a pair of second side parts **82**. The first side part **81** and the pair of second side parts **82** each has an elongated bar shape and a U-shaped cross section orthogonal to a length direction defined with respect to each of the first side part **81** and the pair of second side parts **82**. That is, into the first side part **81** and the pair of second side parts **82**, the outer edge of the glass pane **20**, the display panel **31**, the glass panel unit **40**, and the protection plate **50** is partially inserted (see FIG. **3**). Note that the frame part **80** may be made of a resin material. The frame part **80** may be made of a metal material.

(36) The cover **90** is a member for protecting the driver **32** and the circuit part **60**. The cover **90** is in the shape of a rectangular box with one surface being open. The cover **90** is disposed on the first surface **21** of the glass pane **20**. In particular, as illustrated in FIG. **3**, the cover **90** is disposed on the first surface **21** of the glass pane **20** to cover the driver **32** and the circuit part **60**. Note that the cover **90** may be made of a resin material. The cover **90** may be made of a metal material.

(1-3) Example of Use

(37) As shown in FIG. **11**, the display device **10** of the present embodiment is configured to display the image **P10** by the display panel **31**. Moreover, the display device **10** is a transmissive display device, and thus, a back (background) is visible through the display device **10**. That is, the display device **10** is configured to show the background and show a video such as the image **P10** as needed. Moreover, the display device **10** is configured to display desired information as the image **P10** by superimposing the image **P10** on the background without impairing the visibility of the background. In an example, the display device **10** is applicable to a movable object **100** as shown in FIG. **12**. In this case, an object to which the display device **10** is to be attached may be a movable object body **110** of the movable object **100**. Here, the movable object **100** is a vehicle, and is, in this embodiment, an automobile. That is, the movable object body **110** is a car body. The display device **10** is mounted as a window (windshield) of the movable object **100** on the movable object body **110**. In this case, the display device **10** is configured to display various types of drive assistance information such as vehicle speed information, navigation information, pedestrian information, front vehicle information, lane departure information, and vehicle condition information by superimposition on the background by the display panel **31** to make a user visually recognize the information.

(38) Note that the display device **10** is applicable not only to the automobile but may be applicable also to a movable object, such as a two-wheel vehicle, a train, an aircraft, construction machinery, and a marine vessel, other than the automobile. Moreover, the display device **10** is applicable not only to the movable object but may be applicable also to a stationary object. Examples of the stationary object include vending machines, showcases, and facilities. Also in the case of the vending machines, the showcases, and facilities, the display device **10** is usable as a window. Note that examples of the facilities include dwelling houses (e.g., detached dwelling houses, multiple dwelling houses), non-dwelling houses (e.g., factories, commercial facilities, amusement facilities, hospitals, offices, and buildings).

(2) Variation

(39) The embodiment in the present disclosure is not limited to the embodiment described above. Rather, the embodiment described above may be readily modified in various manners depending on a design choice or any other factor without departing from the scope of the present disclosure. Variations of the embodiment described above will be enumerated below.

(40) In the embodiment described above, the display device **10** has a rectangular shape, but the display device **10** may have a desired shape such as a circular shape or a polygonal shape. That is, the glass pane **20**, the display panel **31**, the glass panel unit **40**, and the protection plate **50** do not have to have a rectangular shape but may have a desired shape such as a circular shape or a polygonal shape. Moreover, the shape and/or size of the display device **10** are/is determined based on applications of the display device **10**. For example, the display device **10** may have a shape according to a window (windshield, side window, rear window, or the like) of the movable object **100**.

(41) In a variation, the display device **10** does not have to include the protection plate **50**. Moreover, the display device **10** does not have to include the circuit part **60**. Moreover, the display device **10** does not have to include the buffer member **70**. Moreover, the display device **10** does not have to include the frame part **80**. Moreover, the display device **10** does not have to include the cover **90**.

(42) In a variation, the glass pane **20** may include a functional layer having a desired physical property on at least one of the first surface **21** or the second surface **22**. The function layer is, for example, a film (infrared reflective film, ultraviolet reflecting film) which reflects light of a specific wavelength, a glass film for improving strength, an anti-reflection coating, or the like. The function layer may be formed by coating or may be formed by affixing a film. This similarly applies to the display panel **31**, the glass panel unit **40**, and the protection plate **50**.

(43) In a variation, the glass pane **20** may be a decorated bent glass pane, a laminated bent glass pane, or a bent glazing pane. The glass pane **20** is not limited to the bent glass pane but may alternatively be a flat glass. That is, the glass pane **20** does not have to have the curved surface part **202** but may have only the flat surface part **201**.

(44) In the embodiment described above, the display panel **31** of the display unit **30** is a display (transparent OLED display) including a transparent OLED but may be, for example, a transparent liquid crystal or transparent LED display. That is, as the display panel **31**, a conventionally known transmissive display or transparent display may be adopted.

(45) In a variation, the display panel **31** may be bonded via an intermediate film to the glass panel unit **40**. When the intermediate film is used, a shatterproof effect of glass can be expected in case of damage on the display panel **31** and/or the glass panel unit **40**. Examples of a material for the intermediate film include EVA, PVB, an ionomer resin, and a polyolefin-based adhesive polymer. The intermediate film is preferably transmissive to visible light so that the background is visible through the intermediate film. In particular, the intermediate film is preferably colorless and transparent. Note that the display panel **31** and the glass panel unit **40** may be bonded to each other by direct bonding of resin embedding. That is, the display panel **31** and the glass panel unit **40** may be bonded to each other by an adhesive without a gap therebetween. Examples of the adhesive include an optically clear adhesive (OCA) and an ultraviolet curing resin.

(46) In a variation, the configuration of the glass panel unit **40** is not limited to the configuration described above but may be the same configuration as the conventionally known vacuum insulated glass unit. In an example, the glass panel unit **40** may have a configuration without the exhaust port **47**. Since a glass panel unit without an exhaust port is known, the description thereof is not particularly given.

(47) In a variation, the glass panel unit **40** may be bonded to the glass pane **20** via the intermediate film as described above. Note that the glass panel unit **40** and the glass pane **20** may be bonded to each other by direct bonding of resin embedding. That is, the glass panel unit **40** and the glass pane **20** may be bonded to each other by the adhesive as described above without a gap therebetween.

(48) In a variation, the protection plate **50** may be bonded to the display panel **31** via the intermediate film as described above. Note that the protection plate **50** and the display panel **31** may be bonded to each other by direct bonding of resin embedding. That is, the protection plate **50** and the display panel **31** may be bonded to each other by an adhesive without a gap therebetween.

(3) Aspects

(49) A first aspect of the present disclosure is a display device (10) and includes a glass pane (20), a display panel (31) which is transmissive, and a glass panel unit (40). The display panel (31) faces a prescribed area (210) of the glass pane (20) and is within the prescribed area (210). The glass panel unit (40) is disposed between the prescribed area (210) of the glass pane (20) and the display panel (31), is within the prescribed area (210), and has an internal space (44) which is in a pressure-reduced condition. With this aspect, durability is improved while thermal insulation properties are improved.

(50) A second aspect is a display device (10) referring to the first aspect. In the second aspect, the glass pane (20) has an attachment area (211) for attachment to an object (110). The attachment area (211) is in an area not overlapping the prescribed area (210) in the glass pane (20). This aspect facilitates attachment of the display device (10) to the object (110).

(51) A third aspect is a display device (10) referring to the first or second aspect. In the third aspect, the glass pane (20) has a flat surface part (201) and a curved surface part (202). The prescribed area (210) is in the flat surface part (201). This aspect facilitates disposition of the display panel (31).

(52) A fourth aspect is a display device (10) referring to any one of the first to third aspects. In the fourth aspect, the display device (10) further includes a driver (32) configured to drive the display panel (31). The driver (32) is disposed not to overlap the display panel (31). With this aspect, the driver (32) is disposed at a place where the driver (32) has no influence over the visibility of an image (P10) provided by the display panel (31).

(53) A fifth aspect is a display device (10) referring to the fourth aspect. In the fifth aspect, the driver (32) is disposed on an opposite surface of the glass panel unit (40) from the glass pane (20). With this aspect, the glass panel unit (40) is used also to protect the driver (32) from heat.

(54) A sixth aspect is a display device (10) referring to any one of the first to fifth aspects. In the sixth aspect, the prescribed area (210) has a transmissive area (210a) and a non-transmissive area (210b) surrounding the transmissive area (210a). The glass panel unit (40) has an outer edge in the non-transmissive area (210b). With this aspect, the outer edge of the glass panel unit (40) is hidden by the non-transmissive area (210b).

(55) A seventh aspect is a display device (10) referring to the sixth aspect. In the seventh aspect, the non-transmissive area (210b) is a darkly colored area. With this aspect, the outer edge of the glass panel unit (40) is hidden by the non-transmissive area (210b).

(56) An eighth aspect is a display device (10) referring to the sixth or seventh aspect. In the eighth aspect, the glass panel unit (40) has an exhaust port (47) sealed with a sealing material (48). The exhaust port (47) is in the non-transmissive area (210b). This aspect makes the exhaust port (47) less visually obvious.

(57) A ninth aspect is a display device (10) referring to any one of the first to eighth aspects. In the ninth aspect, the glass pane (20) has a strength higher than a strength of the display panel (31) and higher than a strength of the glass panel unit (40). With this aspect, the display panel (31) and the glass panel unit (40) is protected by the glass pane (20).

(58) The tenth aspect is a movable object (100) and includes: the display device (10) of any one of the first to ninth aspects; and a movable object body (110) on which the display device (10) is mounted as a window. With this aspect, durability is improved while thermal insulation properties are improved.

REFERENCE SIGNS LIST

(59) **10** Display Device **20** Glass Pane **201** Flat Surface Part **202** Curved Surface Part **210** Prescribed Area **210a** Transmissive Area **210b** Non-Transmissive Area **211** Attachment Area **31** Display Panel **32** Driver **40** Glass Panel Unit **44** Internal Space **47** Exhaust Port **48** Sealing Material **P10** Image **100** Movable Object **110** Movable Object Body

Claims

1. A display device comprising: a glass pane; a display panel facing a prescribed area of the glass pane, the display panel being within the prescribed area, and being transmissive; a glass panel unit provided between the prescribed area of the glass pane and the display panel, the glass panel unit being within the prescribed area and having an internal space which is in a pressure-reduced condition; and a driver configured to drive the display panel, wherein the driver is disposed not to overlap the display panel, the driver is disposed on an opposite surface of the glass panel unit from the glass pane, and the glass panel unit is between the driver and the prescribed area of the glass pane.
2. The display device of claim 1, wherein the glass pane has an attachment area for attachment to an object, and the attachment area is in an area not overlapping the prescribed area in the glass pane.
3. The display device of claim 1, wherein the glass pane has a flat surface part and a curved surface part, and the prescribed area is in the flat surface part.
4. The display device of claim 1, wherein the prescribed area includes a transmissive area and a non-transmissive area surrounding the transmissive area, and the glass panel unit has an outer edge in the non-transmissive area.
5. The display device of claim 4, wherein the non-transmissive area is a darkly colored area.
6. A display device comprising: a glass pane; a display panel facing a prescribed area of the glass pane, the display panel being within the prescribed area, and being transmissive; and a glass panel unit between the prescribed area of the glass pane and the display panel, the glass panel unit provided within the prescribed area and having an internal space which is in a pressure-reduced condition, wherein the prescribed area includes a transmissive area and a non-transmissive area surrounding the transmissive area, the glass panel unit has an outer edge in the non-transmissive area, the glass panel unit has an exhaust port sealed with a sealing material, and the exhaust port is in the non-transmissive area.
7. A display device comprising: a glass pane; a display panel facing a prescribed area of the glass pane, the display panel being within the prescribed area, and being transmissive; and a glass panel unit between the prescribed area of the glass pane and the display panel, the glass panel unit provided within the prescribed area and having an internal space which is in a pressure-reduced condition, wherein the glass pane has a strength higher than a strength of the display panel and higher than a strength of the glass panel unit.
8. A movable object comprising: the display device of claim 1; and a movable object body on which the display device is mounted as a window.
9. The display device of claim 2, wherein the glass pane has a flat surface part and a curved surface part, and the prescribed area is in the flat surface part.
10. The display device of claim 2, wherein the prescribed area includes a transmissive area and a non-transmissive area surrounding the transmissive area, and the glass panel unit has an outer edge in the non-transmissive area.
11. The display device of claim 3, wherein the prescribed area includes a transmissive area and a non-transmissive area surrounding the transmissive area, and the glass panel unit has an outer edge in the non-transmissive area.
12. The display device of claim 5, wherein the glass panel unit has an exhaust port sealed with a sealing material, and the exhaust port is in the non-transmissive area.
13. The display device of a claim 2, wherein the glass pane has a strength higher than a strength of the display panel and higher than a strength of the glass panel unit.

14. The display device of a claim 3, wherein the glass pane has a strength higher than a strength of the display panel and higher than a strength of the glass panel unit.
